

Responding to the World's Most Influential Letter

Lesson 29 Questions

First Day: Read the Lesson 28 Notes.

The notes and lecture fortify the truth of the passage for understanding and application to daily life.

1. How did the lecture impact your perspective on the Church?

2. What portion of the notes encouraged or challenged you to consider how you show love to believers?

Note: The following questions offer the opportunity to think about all you have learned in Romans. Walk back through the book, recalling what Paul wrote and reflecting on the Holy Spirit's work in your life through this study.

Second Day: Review Romans 1:1–3:20.

Paul greeted believers in Rome and reminded them of humanity's need for God's righteousness.

3. a. From Romans 1:1-17, how did Paul describe himself and the believers in Rome?

   b. From Romans 1:18–3:20, how did Paul describe humanity and sin?

4. What do you learn about God from His responses to sin in these opening chapters?

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5. Which of Paul's descriptions describe you? Why is it difficult but important to accept the truth about your sin?

Third Day: Review Romans 3:21–8:39.

Paul explained how God accomplished salvation by grace through faith in Jesus Christ.

6. Review Romans 3:21-31 for the following questions.
    a. How did Paul explain God's role in saving sinners? (See also Romans 6:23; 7:24-25; 8:32; and other relevant verses from Romans 3:21–8:39.)

    b. How did Paul describe Jesus Christ's part in God's salvation plan? (See also Romans 5:11, 18; 6:4-5, 7; 8:1; and other relevant verses from Romans 3:21–8:39.)

    c. How do people access the righteousness God makes available through Jesus Christ? (See also Romans 4:18-22; 5:1; 6:11; and other relevant verses from Romans 3:21–8:39.)

7. From Romans 8, how does the Holy Spirit empower a believer's new life in Christ? (See also Ephesians 1:13-14.)

8. What is your response to God's righteousness displayed in His multifaceted plan to save sinners by faith?

Fourth Day: Review Romans 9:1–11:36.

Paul worshipped God after explaining His sovereign plan to save both Jews and Gentiles.

9. a. From Romans 3:9-20, who deserves to be saved?

    b. From Romans 9:14-16, what motivates God to save people? How does this impact you or prompt you to worship God? (See also Romans 11:33-36.)

10. Review Romans 9:25-29; 10:17-21; 11:7-11, 25-27. In your own words, explain the plan God revealed for saving both Jews and Gentiles.

11. a. Read John 15:26-27 with Romans 10:1, 14-17. How does God awaken hearts to call on the name of the Lord for salvation?

    b. Whom will you tell about Jesus this week?

Fifth Day: Review Romans 12:1–16:27.

Paul concluded his letter by calling believers to love and live holy lives.

12. a. From Romans 12 and 13, what did Paul say should characterize a believer's new life in Christ?

    b. How does God make this type of life possible? (Skim Romans 5 and 8.)

13. a. In Romans 14–16, what instructions did Paul give and what personal example did he offer?

    b. What do you find most challenging or compelling about Paul's instructions or example?

14. How would you like the gospel of God's righteousness to transform your thinking, affections, behavior, and relationships?

Sixth Day: Review Romans 1–16.

The Holy Spirit grows believers in holiness as they reflect on and rightly respond to the gospel.

15. How has reflecting on and responding to the gospel impacted your love for God this week?

No homiletics for Group and Administrative Leaders

Next step: Continue this lesson with group discussion, lecture, and notes.

Lecture Notes

Lesson 29 Notes

Summary

Focus Verse

"I myself am convinced, my brothers and sisters, that you yourselves are full of goodness, filled with knowledge and competent to instruct one another. Yet I have written you quite boldly on some points to remind you of them again, because of the grace God gave me." (Romans 15:14-15)

Outline

- What Paul's Letter to the Romans Reveals
- What Paul's Letter to the Romans Requires

Engage

What helps you remember and understand what is most important? We can easily forget or disregard essential facts, priorities, or obligations when information constantly bombards our lives. Reminders such as church bells, checklists, changing seasons, and sunsets and sunrises help keep us mindful of important rhythms and responsibilities. However, people often resent or ignore reminders that feel irrelevant and unnecessary. **An intentional focus on what matters most helps us navigate life well.** What truth is truly worthy of our regular, thoughtful attention?

Paul wrote his letter to believers in Rome to remind them of God's powerful gospel of righteousness by faith in Jesus Christ. Like us, Roman Christians were not immune to struggles such as external persecution and internal division. Paul's carefully delivered reminders present essential truths that offer help for daily life and hope for eternity. Paul masterfully explained why we need God's righteousness, how God provides it, and its comprehensive impact on believers today and forever. A lifetime of study cannot exhaust the depth and wonder of the gospel's timeless truths. The Holy Spirit continuously works through them to sanctify and fortify believers. **The Holy Spirit grows believers in holiness as they reflect on and rightly respond to the gospel.** An ongoing focus on the gospel yields fresh wonder, worship, and surrender in a believer's life.

What Paul's Letter to the Romans Reveals

About Humanity – 1:1–3:20

"There is no one righteous, not even one; there is no one who understands; there is no one who seeks God."[1] **As Paul laid the foundation of his letter, he confronted believers in Rome with a transformative truth: They were sinners called by God to belong to Jesus Christ.**

1. **No one righteous:** Romans 3:10-11

Called to Belong (1:1-17) – By grace, God called, emboldened, and motivated Paul to declare the gospel to Jews and then Gentiles. Through faith in the gospel, the believers in Rome became God's holy people. **Paul hoped they might help him spread the gospel "because it is the power of God that brings salvation to everyone who believes."**[2]

***Condemned by Sin (1:18–3:20)* –** Paul reminded his letter's recipients of their sin and need for Christ's righteousness. God created people in His image to recognize Him in the world He created and respond to His kindness with repentance. Nothing is more important than how we respond to God. When people suppress knowledge of God, sin deceives, ensnares, and destroys them. They worship created things instead of their Creator. **Paul pointed out that even people who try to be good apart from God's saving grace remain blind to their sin and under God's wrath.** All people break God's moral law. In the end, people have absolutely no excuse for sin.

About God – 3:21–11:36

After discussing the truth about humanity's sin, Paul pronounced the totality of God's triumph over sin through Jesus Christ. He wrote, "But now apart from the law the righteousness of God has been made known, to which the Law and the Prophets testify. This righteousness is given through faith in Jesus Christ to all who believe. There is no difference between Jew and Gentile."[3]

***Justified by Faith (3:21–5:11)* – The gospel Paul proclaimed powerfully displays God's power to save sinners.** By offering Jesus to die in their place, God makes His righteousness known and accessible to anyone—Jew and non-Jew—through faith.[4] Gentiles did not have God's law, and the Jews, who had it, could not keep it. As God of both Jew and Gentile, He compassionately made faith the only path for all people to be justified—declared "not guilty"—and released from sin's penalty. God has always justified people through faith in Him and His promises.[5] Today, believers trust in the completed work of Jesus Christ, which fulfills the "Law and the Prophets." Christ's resurrection secures believers' justification and confirms sin's penalty has been fully paid: "Therefore, since we have been justified through faith, we have peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ."[6]

***Triumphed over Sin's Power (5:12-8:39)* – Through union with Christ and the indwelling Holy Spirit, God shatters sin's power to enslave believers.** "Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus"[7]; Christ's gift of righteousness triumphs over the inherited effects of Adam's sin. By grace through faith, God unites believers with Jesus so they can share in His death to sin and live new resurrection lives in, through, and for Him.[8] Jesus's blood reconciles people to God and redeems them from sin's grip. Believers permanently belong to the Lord: "For the wages of sin is death, but the gift of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord."[9] Even as believers struggle against sin's ongoing temptation, the Holy Spirit helps them.[10] Jesus and the Holy Spirit intercede for believers, giving them strength and hope to eagerly await God's promised eternal glory.[11] If you are a believer, God has justified you and lovingly holds you. You can rest securely in your salvation, your adoption, and God's glorious purposes amidst suffering.

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2. **Powerful gospel:** Romans 1:16
3. **Righteousness given:** Romans 3:21-23
4. **Righteousness by faith:** Romans 3:28
5. **Old Testament faith:** Romans 4
6. **Peace with God:** Romans 5:1
7. **No condemnation:** Romans 8:1
8. **New lives:** Romans 6:4-7, 11-14
9. **Gift of life:** Romans 6:23
10. **Holy Spirit's help:** Romans 7:24–8:17
11. **Jesus intercedes:** Romans 8:26-27, 34

***Sovereign in Salvation (9:1–11:36)* – In mercy and wisdom, God sovereignly reigns over every person's eternal destiny.** God's plan of salvation proves He is righteous and faithful to His promises. Through Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, Paul illustrated that God calls people to salvation according to His plan and gracious purposes, not because of their high moral standards, nationality, or accomplishments. No one meets God's righteous standard. In mercy, God calls some to belong to Him through faith from every nation on earth.[12]

While God sovereignly chooses His children, He does not create unbelief. "Everyone who calls on the name of the Lord will be saved,"[13] but people who fail to call on the Lord in faith remain responsible for rejecting the gospel.[14] God foretold that He would work through Israel's partial hardening and unbelief to reach the Gentiles. Then through Gentile faith, God would provoke Israel to jealousy.[15] Paul proclaimed, "In this way all Israel will be saved."[16] **The mystery of God's sovereignty and human responsibility working together in salvation led Paul to praise God's wisdom, knowledge, unsearchable judgments, and complete control.[17]**

About the Church – 12:1–16:27

Paul boldly reminded believers that God displays His righteousness in and through His people's lives. All who put their faith in Jesus become part of Christ's body, the Church universal, which includes all believers: "In Christ we, though many, form one body and each member belongs to all the others."[18]

***United in Christ (12:1-21)* – Paul reminded the local church in Rome that, as part of Christ's body and united in Him, believers come together as the Church to offer their bodies "as a living sacrifice, holy and pleasing to God—this is your true and proper worship."[19]** As believers surrender to God, He renews their minds and conforms them to the image of Jesus.[20] God's Spirit unifies believers with various personalities and gifts, calling them to humbly serve one another and work together to overcome evil with good.

***Ambassadors for Christ (13:1-14)* –** After telling believers, "Do not conform to the pattern of this world,"[21] Paul reminded them that it matters how they live while awaiting Christ's promised return. Believers share a gospel mission, displaying God's righteousness. The hope of Christ's second coming compels believers to honor earthly authorities that God Himself has positioned. Selfishness has no place among believers, who owe one another and Christ an endless debt of love. **Christian love fulfills God's law, offering a life-giving witness of God's transforming power to a rebellious world.**

***Diverse by Design (14:1–16:27)* –** Paul's message of unity, honor, and love addressed the daily challenges of believers in Rome's diverse Christian community, which was filled with varying traditions and preferences. God accepts all believers in Christ. God brings Himself glory by saving many different people. He empowers believers to trust Him and live in unity and mutual acceptance without judgment. Paul encouraged his audience, "May the God of hope fill you with

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12. **God's mercy:** Romans 9:14-16
13. **Call and be saved:** Romans 10:13
14. **Responsible for rejection:** John 12:48; Hebrews 3:12
15. **God's plan foretold:** Romans 9:25-29; 10:17-21; 11:7-11, 25-27
16. **All Israel saved:** Romans 11:26
17. **Paul's praise:** Romans 11:33-36
18. **Christ's body:** Romans 12:5
19. **Living sacrifices:** Romans 12:1
20. **Conformed to Jesus:** Romans 8:29
21. **Not conformed:** Romans 12:2

all joy and peace as you trust in him, so that you may overflow with hope by the power of the Holy Spirit."[22] **Diversity within Christ's body is essential to the gospel mission, as it extends the reach of God's righteousness beyond what one person, language, or method could accomplish alone.**

What Paul's Letter to the Romans Requires

Submission to God – 1:1–3:20

Paul's words implore all people to recognize sin's destructive impact and submit their lives to God, who sent Jesus to defeat sin. He asked, "Do you show contempt for the riches of his kindness, forbearance and patience, not realizing that God's kindness is intended to lead you to repentance?"[23]

God's Call (1:1-32) – God actively calls people to live for Him, not themselves. Paul responded by unashamedly proclaiming the gospel and seeking to strengthen other believers. In submission to God, Paul patiently waited to visit Rome according to God's time and plan—as a prisoner for Christ.[24] In contrast, Romans 1 also describes people who saw "God's invisible qualities—his eternal power and divine nature"—displayed through creation's splendor and suppressed the truth about God.[25] **Through creation and gospel messengers, God continues to call people to seek and obey Him.**

God's Judgment (2:1-29) – As the perfect judge, only God's assessment of our righteousness determines our eternity. God knows every person's heart, mind, actions, and opportunities. Acknowledging our sinful condition and personal need for God's righteousness turns our attention to God rather than the sins of others. God rewards believers who persistently seek Him with eternal life in His presence. Unbelievers, who reject God's kindness and deny their need of His grace, will spend eternity separated from Him. **When people surrender to God as the righteous judge and confess their need for His saving grace, His Holy Spirit purifies their hearts.[26]**

God's Faithfulness (3:1-20) – In Paul's concluding statements about sin, he asserted that all people are condemned for their sins and accountable to God. Because of our fallen nature, we quickly excuse sinful behavior. We might even claim that our sin resulted from God's unfaithfulness to us, or that His judgment is unjust because we cannot help ourselves. However, Paul proved God faithfully offers people His Word and His witnesses, calling us to acknowledge sin and turn from it. **God's perfect law reveals our sin and demands that we abandon our excuses and submit to Him as Lord of all.**

Faith Not Works – 3:21–8:39

Next, Paul reminded believers that "the righteous will live by faith."[27] **From beginning to end, they live in faithful response to God's saving work, union with Christ, and the enlivening Holy Spirit.**

Believe God (3:21–5:11) – Paul offered Abraham as proof of God's compassionate choice to save all people by faith. Abraham "did not waver through unbelief regarding the promise of God, but was strengthened in his faith and gave glory to God, being fully persuaded that God had power

22. **Joy, peace, hope:** Romans 15:13
23. **Call to repentance:** Romans 2:4
24. **Prisoner for Christ:** Ephesians 3:1; 4:1
25. **God's qualities:** Romans 1:20
26. **Circumcised hearts:** Romans 2:28-29
27. **Live by faith:** Romans 1:17

to do what he had promised."[28] God loves you so much that He made a way to judge your sin and spare you from its consequences. He provided Jesus to take your place and give you access to Christ's righteousness as your own by faith. **Trust what God has done and rejoice in the peace and hope that salvation through Jesus secures.**

Follow Christ (5:12–7:25) – Union with Christ liberates believers from sin's destructive reign in their lives.[29] **God frees believers from guilt, shame, and condemnation to submit to Christ's reign of grace.** He empowers them to live for Him, not sin. Sin's temptations persist while this world remains, but temptations do not determine a believer's destiny. Paul commanded believers to fully embrace their sanctification through new life in Christ: "Count yourselves dead to sin but alive to God in Christ Jesus."[30] The law shows believers their need for Christ's saving power, even as they have died to the law's power to condemn them.

Live by the Spirit (8:1-39) – Believers grow in holiness through surrender to the Holy Spirit's life-giving leadership rather than through obligation to the law.[31] The Holy Spirit regenerates believers, giving them peaceful minds, confidence in Christ's return, adoption to sonship, assurance of salvation, and hopeful perseverance in trials.[32] Paul asked, "If God is for us, who can be against us?" The answer is no one! "He who did not spare his own Son, but gave him us for us all—how will he not also, along with him, graciously give us all things?"[33] In every hardship and struggle, Paul called believers "more than conquerors through him who loved us."[34] **God calls His people to pursue holiness boldly and rest securely in His purposes, salvation, and never-ending love.**

Humble Service – 9:1–11:36

God's promise to save both Jews and Gentiles by faith moved Paul to action and worship. He exclaimed, "Oh, the depth of the riches of the wisdom and knowledge of God!"[35]

Selfless Concern (9:1–10:21) – The believer's secure life in Christ so astounded Paul that he grieved for fellow Jews who were pursing righteousness by works rather than faith. How is a believer to regard unbelievers? With intense concern and prayer.[36] How is a believer to help the lost? Motivated by selfless concern, we can share the good news about salvation through faith in the death and resurrection of the Lord, Jesus Christ.[37] **Paul's concern for others motivated him to share the gospel unashamedly.[38]**

Humble Worship (11:1-36) – Paul called believing Gentiles to humbly thank God for saving them by faith.[39] In his doxology, Paul offered worship as an alternative to prideful arguments with God[40] or arrogant boasting about self-worth. **Humble worship is the appropriate response to God's glory and unsearchable wisdom.** Though God does not owe people an explanation for how He rules His creation, He lovingly shows us His mercy, compassion, sovereignty, wisdom, and power so we can live in right relationship with Him. God invites humanity to exalt Him above themselves, marveling at the portions of His nature He has graciously revealed.

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28. **Faith in God:** Romans 4:20-21
29. **Sin's mastery:** Romans 5:21; 6:14
30. **Dead to sin:** Romans 6:11
31. **Holy Spirit's help:** Romans 8:4-14, 26-27
32. **Assurance:** Romans 8:14-17; Ephesians 1:13-14
33. **God's provision:** Romans 8:31b-32
34. **More than conquerors:** Romans 8:37
35. **God's deep wisdom:** Romans 11:33
36. **Concern and prayer:** Romans 9:1-4; 10:1
37. **Message about Christ:** Romans 10:14-17
38. **Paul's gospel work:** Romans 1:1, 16-17; 11:13-16; 15:17-20
39. **Be humble:** Romans 11:17-21
40. **Arguing with God:** Romans 9:19-21

Made for God

The Doctrine of Humanity: Creation and Purpose

In his doxology, Paul declared about God, "For from him and through him and for him are all things. To him be the glory forever! Amen."[1] **God made people in His image to bring Him glory and enjoy relationship with Him.**[2] However, sin tarnished God's reflection in humanity and robbed people of right standing with Him. Paul proclaimed that a right relationship with God could be restored only one way: by God's powerful grace through faith in Jesus Christ and the new life of the Spirit. Restored relationship with God opens the door for believers to enjoy God and increasingly reflect Jesus to a broken world.[3]

Because God made all people in His image,[4] He impartially offers saving righteousness, reconciliation, and redemption to all people the same way: by faith. Once alive to God in Christ, believers of every generation and nationality belong to God as beloved children.[5] The Holy Spirit enables believers to have fellowship with God and one another. New life in the Spirit enables believers to glorify God here on earth as they await their final glorification when Christ returns.

When people do not believe that their purpose is to glorify their Creator and enjoy a relationship with Him, they seek their purpose within themselves, exalting themselves as lord of their own lives. They also look for purpose in the world around them through pleasure, pleasing people, and idolized earthly priorities. **Those who refuse to live for God remain enslaved to sin and death.**[6]

But when we accept that we were made for God, His offer of restored relationship through faith in Jesus Christ draws us into His loving embrace. We find rest from trusting self-righteous works and living under sin's dominion. We discover who God made us to be. **The Spirit's presence in us and union with Christ soften us to the Lord's sanctifying work in our lives, and we progressively find more delight in God's glory than our own.** How has the gospel Paul proclaimed called you to embrace and rejoice in your God-given purpose to live for the one who made you, loves you, and died to save you?

1. **Doxology:** Romans 11:36
2. **God's glory:** Isaiah 43:7
3. **Like Him:** 2 Corinthians 3:18; Colossians 3:10
4. **Image-bearers:** Genesis 1:26-27; 5:1
5. **God's children:** Romans 8:14-16; 1 John 3:2
6. **Enslaved to sin:** Romans 6:19-21

Sacrificial Living – 12:1–16:27

In view of God's mercy and love, Paul boldly called believers to allow God's righteousness and love to pervade every area of their lives. He said, "Therefore, I urge you, brothers and sisters, in view of God's mercy, to offer your bodies as a living sacrifice, holy and pleasing to God—this is your true and proper worship."[41]

41. **Living sacrifices:** Romans 12:1

Unity and Love (12:1-21) – The powerful gospel Paul preached resulted in believers belonging to Christ and one another. Unified believers bring glory to Jesus and demonstrate God's love to the world. But before unity, Paul commanded surrender to God and right thinking about self. Why? Because believers cannot manufacture unity or sincere love in their own power. However, saved sinners who ponder their reconciliation to God through His grace, mercy, and lavish love grow in gratitude, humility, and love for God and others.[42] **As the Holy Spirit renews believer's minds, they no longer live to please their sinful nature but instead to please God and lovingly serve His people.[43]**

Honor and Love (13:1-14) – Paul described believers' proper behavior: "Clothe yourselves with the Lord Jesus Christ, and do not think about how to gratify the desires of the flesh."[44] In the world's political and social spheres, Christian love looks like honor, respect, and loving your neighbor as yourself. Even when they do not trust or agree with governing authorities, Christians can trust God's love and promises of Christ's return. God establishes earthly authority for His good purposes. **As believers clothe themselves with Christ, He shows them how to live out His love, which does not harm a neighbor but instead shines forth His light.**

Acceptance and Love (14:1–16:27) – Paul urged believers to accept and love one another even when they disagree about disputable matters because "the kingdom of God is not a matter of eating and drinking, but of righteousness, peace and joy in the Holy Spirit."[45] Every believer comes to faith after being shaped by their family, culture, and experiences. On their own, strong and weak believers alike struggle to experience unity without uniformity. **Paul strengthened all believers by reminding them that God will rightly judge His own servants, who already stand accepted in Christ Jesus.** Every believer can overflow with gratitude at this good news and reject the temptation to judge others.

Paul elevated God's kingdom priorities and the glory of Jesus Christ over every personal liberty, preference, or ambition that causes needless division and discord among believers. **The Holy Spirit grows believers in holiness as they reflect on and rightly respond to the gospel.** By example, Paul called believers from across the Roman Empire to remember the good news they had believed and pray, serve, and love with him so that all nations might believe.[46]

Take to Heart

Hold Fast

Whether you came to BSF's study of Romans as an unbeliever, new believer, or mature believer, the gospel's truths remain timelessly life changing. Like the church in Rome, the Church around the world today needs gospel reminders to renew our minds, deepen our love, and call us to new life in Christ. Believers, along with all people, were once condemned by their sin. **Now, through faith in Christ's sacrifice and resurrection, they enjoy justification, redemption, reconciliation, and sanctification.** God's grace reigns over believers' destinies.

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42. Lavish love: Romans 5:5-8
43. Spiritual renewal: Romans 8:5-9
44. Clothed with Christ: Romans 13:14
45. God's kingdom: Romans 14:17
46. All nations: Romans 16:26

God's Spirit enables believers to be transformed into Christlikeness. As believers offer themselves to God, the world's patterns of individualism, selfishness, pride, defensiveness, rebellion, and judgment increasingly give way to unity, generosity, humility, grace, submission, and acceptance. Secured by Christ's saving work on their behalf, believers enjoy a new life of fellowship with their Creator forever. Nothing can separate a believer from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus their Lord.[47] Believers accept one another because they have been accepted and welcomed by God forever.

Apply It

God calls all people to agree with what His Word says about their sin. Paul did not portray sin's grim reality to crush the hearts or discourage the faith of believers in Rome. Instead, recognizing the magnitude of personal sin and humanity's fallen condition positions believers to comprehend the magnitude of God's saving power and grace. No one could accomplish salvation from God's wrath except God. **Will you let the truth of your sinful condition and God's saving power draw you to Him in faith and joy for your salvation?** Will you praise Him for His kindness and grace to sinners and tell everyone about it?

Have you accepted God's gifts of righteousness, reconciliation, justification, and new life through faith in Jesus? If not, God has been calling you throughout this study. Accept God's righteousness through faith in Jesus today. Why did believers in Rome need such bold, detailed reminders of truth they already professed to believe? Why do we? A lifetime of pain and difficulty can dull a believer's grasp of God's triumph over sin and death. Conversely, a lifetime of success and achievement can dampen a believer's sense of total dependence on Christ alone for salvation. **Will you allow the truths of salvation by grace alone through faith alone in Christ alone to deepen your love for God, your desire to live for His glory, and your passion to reach others with the gospel?**

People face a timeless temptation to argue with God about how we think He ought to rule His universe and work in people. What if, instead of arguing with Him, we assume a posture of awe and gratitude for His mercy? **What if, instead of demanding to know God's unsearchable judgments and untraceable paths, we grieve over and pray for the lost, while also eagerly sharing with them the good news about salvation through faith in Jesus Christ?** Ask God for humble gratitude to flood your heart and mind today.

Minds renewed by God lead to hearts filled with wonder, worship, and love for God. But a believer's transformation does not stop with a renewed mind and filled heart. The Holy Spirit constantly works in believers to sanctify them and transform their priorities, practices, words, and relationships. Christianity is not a self-help method. The Holy Spirit moves every believer toward holiness—Christlikeness and humble unity with God's people. What attitudes, behaviors, or relationships does God want to transform in your life? Through faith in Christ, believers are raised from spiritual death to eternal life with God. **If God can raise the dead to life, His power can restore and sanctify you.** Will you let Him? What holds you back from offering every part of your life to God? For "those God foreknew he also predestined to be conformed to the image of His Son, that he might be the firstborn among many brothers and sisters."[48] We proclaim with Paul, "To the only wise God be glory forever through Jesus Christ! Amen."[49]

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47. No separation: Romans 8:39b
48. Conformed to Christ: Romans 8:29
49. Benediction: Romans 16:27

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